NCCA ENTERTAINMENT

THE 13TH PASSENGER

Everyone on that plane is exactly who they say they are. That's the problem.

LOGLINE

When a red-eye diverts to a decommissioned French airfield with a dead passenger who isn't who her passport says she is, the accident investigator called in to sign off on the landing pulls a thread that unravels a black-market identity network built to erase people from their own pasts, and the private intelligence contractor willing to disappear an entire terminal to keep it running.

SYNOPSIS

Flight 714 makes an emergency landing at Saint-Aubin, an airfield decommissioned years ago, after a passenger dies mid-flight under circumstances the manifest can't explain. Dr. Evelyn Mercer, an accident investigator still carrying the bridge collapse that killed her husband, is the only official on site, and the only one who notices that the dead woman and the name on her passport were never the same person. As Eve pulls the thread, she finds the real Leila Haddad hiding in plain sight as a Canadian schoolteacher: architect of MIRROR, the identity program Janus Global turned into an auction floor, and keeper of the Root Ledger, a biometrically locked index that can unmask every false identity Janus ever sold. Janus chief Adrian Vale wants the one woman who can open it before dawn, and he does not believe he is the villain of this story. Trapped in a terminal with more than two hundred strangers, a seven-year-old boy whose mother Janus erased, and a corporate war over who gets to disappear, Eve and Leila have until sunrise to find a third option: expose the machine without handing the people it hid back to the men they were running from.

WHY NOW

A single-location, single-night contained thriller with a global ensemble and a hook every streaming buyer already understands: what if the person next to you isn't who the system says they are. Built for the Netflix international slate: practical production footprint, franchise-ready mythology, and a female investigative lead carrying genuine moral cost rather than a clean win.

COMPARABLE TITLES

THE NIGHT AGENT (paranoia-driven ensemble stakes) • **BODYGUARD** (character-first political thriller tension) • **THE NIGHT MANAGER** (elevated international scale, morally complex antagonist) • **CARRY-ON** (contained-airport thriller mechanics)

GENRE	International Conspiracy Thriller	**FORMAT**	Feature Film, approx. 100 pages
PLATFORM LANE	Netflix (global contained thriller)	**SETTING**	South Korea → France, single night
STATUS	Revision 10, continuity pass	**CO-PROD.**	Korea / France / UK footprint

CONTACT

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THE 13TH PASSENGER: Cast Suggestions

An international ensemble by design. Suggestions favor working actors whose profile carries the film's global, streaming-lane positioning. Final casting to follow availability, chemistry reads, and territory financing.

ROLE	SUGGESTED CASTING
DR. EVELYN "EVE" MERCER, 42 *American accident investigator. Evidence-driven, carrying a testimony that cost her husband his life. The audience's way into the mystery and the moral center of the film.*	Elisabeth Moss • Rebecca Ferguson • Carrie Coon
ADRIAN VALE, 50s *Head of Janus Global. Controlled, precise, genuinely believes he is the last adult in the room. The best villains think they're the hero, and this is that villain.*	Ralph Fiennes • Mads Mikkelsen • Clive Owen
LEILA HADDAD, 32 *Architect of MIRROR and the Root Ledger, hiding in plain sight as a Canadian schoolteacher and guardian to a boy who isn't hers. Carries a choice she never excuses. Never flattened into a redemption arc.*	Golshifteh Farahani • Zar Amir Ebrahimi • Nazanin Boniadi
PARK MIN-JAE, 38 *Korean Air Force Reserve captain running airport security. Duty and procedure define him, until he has to choose which rule actually matters.*	Park Hae-soo • Gang Dong-won • Yoo Yeon-seok
CAMILLE, 30s *French domestic cyber analyst. Sharp, funny under pressure, the technical heart of the ensemble.*	Adèle Exarchopoulos • Noémie Merlant • Souheila Yacoub
CAPTAIN JEAN MOREAU, 56 *French pilot, forty years of bad weather and no patience left for being lied to. The film's conscience in the cockpit.*	Vincent Cassel • Mathieu Kassovitz • Daniel Auteuil
CLAIRE BENOIT, 41 *NGO field coordinator, quietly protecting thirty-one names for eight months before anyone finds out.*	Marion Cotillard • Charlotte Gainsbourg • Léa Drucker
NIGEL CROWTHER, 53 *A British commodities trader on paper, in truth a fraud auditor living under a dead man's name. Class-inflected hostility as armor for real fear.*	Damian Lewis • Dominic West • Toby Stephens
AMADOU DIOP, 46 *A Senegalese diplomat built from a stolen name, once a journalist who wrote about the disappeared. Eighteen years of being edited by other people and no longer flinching at it.*	Djimon Hounsou • Isaach De Bankolé • Omar Sy
DR. EMIKO SATO, 49 *Pediatric surgeon living on a dead surgeon's name, with steady hands and a wedding band she never takes off.*	Rinko Kikuchi • Kyoko Hasegawa • Ryoko Yonekura
INÈS BELKACEM, 28 *A contract translator promised a way out through Lisbon. Brief, devastating, and the reason the film's first act lands.*	Camélia Jordana • Lyna Khoudri • Hafsia Herzi
PARK JOON-HO, 25 *Maritime safety inspector whose signature sits on a page that says everything was fine. Learns what 'trust the record' costs.*	Byeon Woo-seok • Hong Kyung • Lee Do-hyun
ELIAS VOSS, late 20s *Passenger 13. Always at the edge of frame, head down over a phone. Barely seen, never explained.*	Josh O'Connor • Harris Dickinson • Louis Hofmann
NOAH, 7 *A quiet boy told to wait for a woman who will pretend not to know him. A role built on behavior and silence.*	Open casting, ages 6–8, French/international